Work Smarter

Calendar

1. Do you plan your day with the calendar app on your phone?
2. What is the most efficient way to use a calendar?
3. Do you fill every slot, or leave white space between tasks?
4. How much empty time do you need between two meetings?
5. Do you set reminders for the things you must not forget?
6. Does your company make you use its own chat, file, or office app?
7. Which app do you open first when you start your workday?

WeChat at Work

1. Do you use WeChat for work? What frustrates you most about it?
2. Do you use the floating window to switch between two chats?
3. Do you quote or @ people so they actually see your message?
4. Do you mark a chat unread so you come back to it later?
5. How do you keep your personal WeChat away from your work chats?
6. Have you ever sent a work message to the wrong person?
7. What is one WeChat habit that wastes your time?

Focus

1. Have you heard of the Pomodoro Technique? Do you use it?
2. Can you work for 90 minutes straight, or do you need breaks?
3. What usually breaks your focus — your phone, messages, or noise?
4. How do you stop your phone from pulling you away from work?
5. Do you check messages on a schedule, or whenever they arrive?

6. What time of day is your most productive hour? Why?

7. Do you write a to-do list for the day, or just start working?

Tools

1. What about GTD, to-do lists, or the Eisenhower Matrix? Do you use them?

2. Have you ever gone looking for a productivity app? Did it help?

3. What is the one app that actually saves you time every day?

4. Do you use a paper notebook, or only your phone? Why?

5. Have you ever tried a tool and given up after a week?

6. Do you keep a record of your work? What do you use?

7. Would you pay for a productivity app if it really worked?

Habits and Overwork

1. What do you think of "productivity obsession"?

2. Is being busy the same as being productive? Why?

3. Do you ever work on weekends, or do you keep them free?

4. How do you stop a small task from eating a whole afternoon?

5. Do you plan tomorrow's tasks the night before?

6. What is one bad habit you want to break this month?

What Works for You

1. What is your number-one rule for a productive day?

2. Have your habits changed since you started working from home?

3. What do you do when you feel you are getting nothing done?

4. Who is the most organized person you know? What do they do?

5. Is it possible to work smart and still finish on time?

6. What advice would you give a new colleague about staying focused?